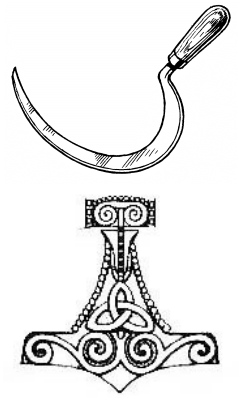


# DER OSCHDRESEGE

## 22. LENZING, 2014



ZUFIEGE ZUM JOE MAREK UN ZUM BRIAN WEIS  
REV - 0 - 2012

### Intonation of the Runes

Each rune is intoned thrice: Sowilo, Jera, Dagaz, Ansuz

### Die Heiliching

*Barscht vun der Oschdra, heilich daer Aldaar un die Schtell  
Beschitz uns mit der Graft vun de Ziewe  
Bei Wudan un Frigg fer der Gemeeschaft zu baue  
Bei Ziu un Zisa fer die Gerechdichkeet un der Fruchsfriede zu erhalde  
Bei Frey un Freya fer die Wohldaat zu schneide un zu sammle  
Bei Dunner un Siwwa fer es Volk vollzumechtiche.  
Bei der Fraa Holle fer es Volk zu erneire  
Bei der Oschdra fer der Welt bei Farrewe zu belewe.  
Wie schmittet der Hammer die Sichel,  
So die Sichel der Hammer fiedert.  
'S iss es Lewesraad, zu saehe un zu schneide  
Barscht vun der Oschdra, heilich daer Aldaar un die Schtell*

*Heel!*

*Heel!*

*Heel!*

### Leseschtick - Reading

Bede's attestation of Eostre among the Angles, from *De temporum ratione*:

*Eosturmonath has a name which is now translated "Paschal month", and which was once called after a goddess of theirs named Eostre, in whose honour feasts were celebrated in that month. Now they designate that Paschal season by her name, calling the joys of the new rite by the time-honoured name of the old observance.*

## Unser Zweck - Our Purpose

*Birth, death, rebirth*

*Are common themes in Deutsch culture.*

*We see them in our seasons, in the land, and in our souls.*

*The reading provides clues as to why we're here today.*

*First, We gather to celebrate the arrival of Spring*

*which heralds the renewal of the Earth.*

*Second, they speak to the nature of our lore*

*regarding the Goddess who lent her name to this season: Oschdra.*

*Very little about Oschdra in the way of ancient lore has survived to reach us. Deutsch oral lore provides some additional insights. Oschdra is counted in Braucherei among the Wane.*

*From Grimm (IV, 1371) we know her name lives on in places in the German lands.*

*We know She is considered to be "White Lady" (III, 908)*

*Along with Holle, Berchta, and others, and She heralds the arrival of Spring.*

*Like our ancestors, we yearn for Oschdra and the return of Spring.*

*She is the goddess of the Dawn, who brings color and joy back to a winter-weary world.*

*Our modern conveniences separate us from the cycle of the seasons*

*Thus, we do not, or cannot, understand fully*

*what the return of Spring meant to our forebears.*

*Yet we do understand and share the desire for,*

*and love of, Earth's beauty and bounty.*

*It is the same longing for the end of winter.*

*Heathen symbols were brought forth by the Deutsch settlers and have become traditions,*

*Though most people are not aware that they are sacred to this radiant deity.*

*The restoration of the land is reflected in the so-called secular imagery of today.*

*The rabbit, or the hare, is long seen in the western German lands as a symbol of fertility.*

*And, of course, the egg represents new life.*

*So today we honor Oschdra*

*The goddess of color*

*The goddess of the radiant dawn*

*The goddess of upspringing light*

*A spectacle who brings joy and blessing*

*To a land and a folk who are eagerly awaiting the springing of life in the land.*

## Der Aaruf - The Invocation

*Liewi Haerrin Oschdra!*

*Ziewerin vum Mariyelight!*

*Farewegewwern!*

*Mir bidde Dich mit uns zu bsuche*

*Un mit uns heit die Oschdre zu feiere*

*Sei unser verehrter Gaschtin*

*un unseri Freindschaft verdeele*

*Helf uns die Winderdunkelheit zerickzugloppe*

*So mir em Friebling sei Mariyelight aablicke kenne*

*Heele!*

*Dear Lady Oschdra!*

*Goddess of the Dawn!*

*Color-Giver!*

*We bid Thee to visit with us*

*and with us today to celebrate Oschdre*

*Be our honored guest*

*and share in our family*

*Help us to beat back the winter darkness*

*So that we can see the dawn of spring.*

*Hail!*

## Es Opfer un Die Eed - Offerings and Oaths

*Losst uns enniche Opfer uff der Aldaar adder in 's Feier yetz schtelle*

*Un wann ennichebber hot en Eed zu bschweere, kumm yetz voraa.*

*If anyone has any offerings, please place them onto the altar, or, later, into the fire.*

*If anyone has any oaths to take, come forward now.*

## Die Heiliching vun de Opfer - Hallowing of the Offerings

*Zu Dir, Liewi Haerrin Oschdra*

*Mir hewwe daer Seidel aa*

*Mir biede daer Met un daer Seider aa*

*Un gewwe die do annere Gschenker*

*Wie 'n Zeichnis zu unserer Dankbaarked*

*un vun unserer Gemeeschaft*

*un vun unserer Gemietlichkeet*

*Darrich Dich binne mir uns fescht aa*

*Losst 's immer so sei!*

*To Thee, Dear Lady Oschdra*

*We lift this stein*

*We offer this mead and this cider*

*And give these other gifts*

*As a symbol of our thankfulness*

*and of our community*

*and our belonging*

*Through Thee we bind ourselves together*

*May it always be so!*

*Heel Oschdra!*

*Heel zu de Ziewe!*

*Heel zu de Vorgenger!*

*Heel zu de Noochkummer!*

*Heel die Gemeeschaft!*

*Hail Oschdra!*

*Hail to the deities!*

*Hail to the ancestors!*

*Hail to the descendants!*

*Hail to the community!*

## Die Ausdeeling - The Distribution

## Der Sege - The Blessing

*When pouring the libations, all say (choose either language):*

*Vun de Ziewe zu der Erd zu uns  
Vun uns zu der Erd zu de Gedder*

*'N Gschenk fer 'n Gschenk  
Heele!*

*From the gods to the Earth to us  
From us to the Earth to the gods*

*A gift for a gift.  
Hail!*

## Zum Schluss - In Closing

*Heit beginne mir en neii Yaahreszeit  
un baue do en sctandhafliches Bindnis zamme  
Mit de Ziewe  
Un darrich unserer allgemee Zweck  
Losst uns zamme immer sctarricker waxe.*

*Der Sege iss beschlosse waerre.*

*Today we begin a new season  
and build here a steadfast alliance together  
with the Deities  
And through our common purpose  
Let us all grow stronger together.*

*This Sege is closed.*

## Zu de Wichde - To The Wights

*Mir gewwe aa en Opfer zu de Wichde  
Vun desem Land  
Un mir bedanke uns 'ne  
Fer ihrer Schirm*

*Heel!*

*We give also an offering to the Wights  
of this Land  
And we are thankful to them  
For their protection*

*Hail!*

## ***Discussion Topics***

The Life, Death, Rebirth Cycle: Yule is associated with Rebirth. At Groundhog Day, we celebrate the Birth of the new. Oschdre is the propagation (the "springing" forth) of life on a larger scale and the childhood phase of the Life cycle.

In Deitsch, Oschdre is a plural noun, perhaps indicating a multiple-day holiday (Grimm, I, 299). This plurality is reflected in Braucherei's three-day observance of Oschdre (March 19, 20, 21). Another possibility is that the Oschdre were multiple goddesses whose individual names, with the exception of one, have been lost to time. The one name we know is Oschdra (Easter).

### **Reckoning Oschdre in Lenzing (March) vs. Oschdret (April)**

Bede's attestation of the Angles' holiday, Eostre, places the observance among that tribe in Eosturmonath, which was the fourth month of the Old English calendar. The fourth month on the Urglaawe calendar is Oschdret, which is a cognate of the Angles' name for the same month. So why do we observe Oschdre in Lenzing (March) rather than April? There could be several reasons for this time discrepancy.

In Urglaawe, we tie Oschdre to the Spring Equinox, but the time of the celebration for our ancestors would very likely have shifted in response to the actual weather conditions for a given year. Thus, those in the south may have generally held their observance earlier than those in the north.

Time reckoning between the ancient past and the present faces many challenges, which complicates research. Keeping that in mind, another theory is that Oschdre was once a longer holiday, (perhaps twelve days like Yuul, Fasching, Wonnetzeit, and, likely, Allelieweziel).

Using current Urglaawe calendar dates, a twelve-day observance would take the holiday to March 31-April 2. Since Urglaawe "days" begin at sundown the preceding night, the evening of March 31 is actually 1. Oschdret/April 1. Thus, the only inconsistency between the theory and the calendar would be the infrequent (if ever?) occurrence of the equinox falling prior to sundown on March 19.

### **Oschdra**

Oschdra's name has a sense of the "east," indicating the dawn. Thus, we see the beauty of the goddess Oschdra in the light of the dawn, particularly the brilliant, multi-colored light manifesting itself in the reflections off of the clouds.

A huge portion of American secular Easter traditions came through the Deitsch culture, including the Easter Rabbit, eggs, and egg trees (see the book *Eastertide in Pennsylvania*, by Alfred L. Shoemaker). Hares and eggs, both symbols of fertility, are sacred to Oschdra. Indeed, after a long winter of muted and paleness, we look forward to the Oschdra painting the world with brilliant color.

Oschdra is also a time for us to honor our relationship with animals. While we are to be live deliberately and consciously within the Zusaagpflicht or Zusaagfassing (see below), the association of the hare and the egg with this holiday provide an opportunity to pay special attention to the role of animals in our lives.

### **Seasonal Focus**

First New Moon after Oschdre = Holzhaane Moon on the traditional Deitsch lunar calendar. The Holzhaane Moon begins on March 31, 2014.

The Woodcock Moon begins with the first new moon after the end of winter. In the natural world at this time we can find the woodcock involved in its complex mating dance at sunsets in open areas near water. The time of hunger is over for those who know the ways of the woodcock. The woodcock lives in marginal lands and finds food where others can't. The woodcock teaches us to adapt to our spring environment and find the new greens and spring foods to cleanse our bodies after the long winter. The woodcock teaches us to take advantage of opportunities given at this time, and to act with speed and timeliness. This is a time of plowing and preparation of our fields for the abundance that is to come. - *Jesse Tobin*

**Stewardship (Verwalting) and Zusaagpflicht / Zusaagfassing** As Spring sets in and the land is teeming with young life, it is a most appropriate time to ponder the virtue of Verwalting is the ancillary virtue of Stewardship. Careful management of resources and the world around us is a core component of Urglaawe, of Braucherei, and of the traditional Deitsch culture. Akin to the Noble Virtues of Discipline and Hospitality, Verwalting helps to create a stable living environment for all of creation.

Stewardship does not mean a lack of progress or an austere lifestyle. It does, though, indicate that progress must not be reckless and that resources must not be squandered in order to achieve immediate goals. It is nearly impossible to live on Earth and not have a negative impact upon or alter one's environment. However, we can strive to minimize the impact, to correct or to ameliorate damages done previously, and to improve our circumstances going forward.

This aspect of Deitsch culture does not emanate from post-modern jargon. The virtue of Stewardship is closely associated with the *Zusaagpflicht* or the Sacred Duty. Several terms are used in Deitsch and English to identify this concept, including also "Zusaagfassing," which translates to "Sacred Promise" in English. The latter had been the more commonly used term until recently, when a book came out by the same title but with a different concept. You will still hear the term used in Braucherei, but the more common term is now the former, *Zusaagpflicht*/Sacred Duty.

No one really knows how old this concept is or even whether it springs forth from the Heathen era, but its concept is certainly consistent with Heathen worldviews. As part of a living culture, though, it has evolved within Deitsch culture (and presumably Palatinate, Swabian, Westphalian, Hessian, Silesian, Alsatian, and Swiss cultures prior to emigration) over the centuries.

Each domain (humanity, plants, and animals) has had, since time immemorial, roles to perform in the cycle of life. The roles evolved over the course of time and developed into an unwritten or spiritual social contract (to use Hobbesian terminology).

Our modern society separates us not only from the reality of the seasons but also from the plant and animal kingdoms. Although we are fortunate enough to live close to the land here in this area, much of our food is still processed and appears as convenient little meals. Stewardship includes recognizing and respecting the loss of life, whether animal or vegetable, that resulted in that meal.

Recently, there have been efforts here in Berks County to reduce sludge farming (the disposal of wastewater on farmlands), to put an end to inhumane treatment on puppy mills, and to end some of the more destructive practices of Big Agro that have resulted in a great volume of food but, very likely, in less actual nutrition. These practices are violations of the Sacred Promise.

As almost any good, effective manager knows, being at the top of an organization does not mean that

power can be used indiscriminately. Eventually, morale breaks down among the staff. Rancor develops, and the health of the organization grows sour. The same arrangement exists throughout the physical world. The fact that mankind can do something does not mean he should do it. Morale is breaking down throughout the physical world as a result of the abuses therein. In a manner of Shyamalan's *The Happening* (which was filmed not far from here, actually), the land may someday rebel or simply to die off.

So what can we, as Urglaawer, along with our fellow Heathens, do? We are a small segment of society. However, small rocks can create a big wake from a splash. The most effective way of making change is to lead by example. Be conscious of the world around you. Take care of your land. Treat the life around you (including humans!) with respect. When possible, know what you are eating and where it comes from (admittedly a difficult task!). Manage your resources with deliberation and a view of the future (this is a large challenge for me when it comes to financial resources). And, to the extent of your personal inclination, act politically for change.

The Deutsch culture, up until very recently, was very geared towards the stewardship of the land and of resources. In most places, it still is. However, a mindless consumer culture is creeping in, and, with its promises of gratification, it is a threat to the culture of this region and to the Zusaagpflicht.

**For Reference**

*The Heathen Nine Noble Virtues (Die Nein Edelreenheide):*

der Mut: Courage

die Waahrheit: Truth

Honor: die Ehr

Fidelity/Troth: die Treie

Discipline: die Addning

Hospitality: die Uffwaarting

Self-Reliance: es Selbschtzuverdraue

Industriousness: die Schaffichheit

Perseverance/Steadfastness: die Ausdauer

Implied among these, but more directly state in Urglaawe, are ancillary virtues called Newwereenheide:

Wisdom: die Weisheit

Introspection: der Selbschtreiguck

Kinship: die Verwandschaft

Generosity: der Edelmut

Curiosity: die Neigierheit

Compassion: es Mitleid

Self-Improvement: die Selbschtverbessering

Stewardship: die Verwalting

Spirituality: die Geischtlichkeet